



1920

PROHIBITION INTRODUCED IN THE US

Following pressure from Christian temperance movements and the Anti-Saloon League, a ban was imposed in the US on the manufacture, sale, and transport of "intoxicating liquors". Prohibition saw a rise in organized crime, which fought over the illegal manufacture and sale of alcohol, and "speakeasies", illicit drinking clubs.

◁ Police oversee the disposal of illegal alcohol

1920

1920 Marcus Garvey, a Jamaican activist, launches the Universal Negro Improvement Association (UNIA)

1921 Campaigner Marie Stopes opens Britain's first birth control clinic, in London

1922 Fascist Benito Mussolini marches on Rome and becomes Italy's prime minister

1920 The Council of the League of Nations holds its first meeting in Paris, France

1921 Charlie Chaplin's first full-length film, *The Kid*, opens in the US

1921 FAMINE IN RUSSIA;

A devastating famine hit Soviet Russia, claiming over five million lives. Severe drought had led to food shortages, which were exacerbated by the impact of the 1917 Revolution and subsequent civil war. Facing anti-Bolshevik revolts in Kronstadt and elsewhere, Vladimir Lenin was forced to ask for foreign aid. Backtracking from strict Communist economics, he introduced a New Economic Policy with some free-market elements.

▷ A Soviet poster exhorts people to remember the hungry



1870-1924

VLADIMIR ILYICH LENIN

A revolutionary Marxist, Lenin founded the Bolshevik Party. Having seized power in 1917, Lenin ruled as a dictator. He suppressed opposition, nationalized banks and industry, and redistributed land.

"We want to achieve a new and better order of society... there must be neither rich nor poor."

LENIN, TO THE RURAL POOR, COLLECTED WORKS, 1903